



SHOWCASE

BAKER RIFLE

In February 1800, the Baker rifle won a competition organized by the British Army’s Board of Ordnance and became the first rifle officially adopted by the British Army. Its novel feature lay in its barrel. With shallow or “slow” rifling—in which the grooves turn by just a quarter along the length of the barrel—it stayed clean, and thus usable, for longer. The Baker rifle was issued to select men at first, and remained in service for more than 35 years.

BAKER RIFLE

Date 1802–37

Origin England

Barrel 30in (76cm)

Caliber .62in (15.8mm)



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Designed by Ezekiel Baker, this rifle was a robust weapon, crafted to keep on working even under the most difficult conditions. With its short barrel (30in/76cm instead of the more customary 39in/99cm), it was not particularly accurate, but was still a great improvement over the smoothbore musket then in general use.

◀ **MALLET**

To begin with, small mallets were issued with Baker rifles to ram down the ball with the ramrod, but these were soon found to be unnecessary as hand pressure alone was sufficient.